

The Benefits of Music Education

Research continues to prove that music education supports children's cognitive, social, and emotional development in robust and incredible ways.



**There is a Staggering Lack of
Music Education in NYC**

The Benefits of Music Education



Music Strengthens the Brain

The process of learning and playing an instrument increases brain power and functionality, resulting in a boosted IQ and improved concentration. Music accelerates brain development for babies and kids, enhancing fine and gross motor skills, executive function, and sensory development.



Music Improves Success in School & Life

Children who study music perform better in school. Positive attributes learned through music-making, such as confidence, independence, perseverance, leadership, and personal responsibility, prepare you for life-long success.



Music Nurtures the Mind & Body

Music education supports students' social and emotional well-being. Studying music nurtures creativity, builds empathy, and helps kids better express their emotions and manage anxiety.



Music Builds Community & Advances Equity

Music brings us together. When making music with others, such as in a group class, chamber group, or ensemble, students are introduced to new experiences and points of view. Music connects different cultures and advances equity and belonging.

ETM's Impact

Research shows that students who have access to Education Through Music's music education programs receive substantial long-term benefits. Metis Associates, a NYC-based research firm, conducted a comprehensive evaluation of the ETM program during the 2023-24 school year and preliminary findings reveal the importance of music education and positive findings across many areas, including academic achievement, social emotional learning, and positive school culture.

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Of schools had stronger math achievement

93%

Of students reported growth in attentiveness

80%

Of teachers saw growth in students' self-confidence

96%

Of teachers saw growth in students' oral expression

85%

Of schools had stronger ELA achievement

69%

Of teachers saw growth in students' teamwork

65%

Of teachers saw growth in students' independence

65%

Of teachers saw growth in students' problem solving

94%

Of students feel they and their families are welcomed at school

Music Education in Action

Featured, In the News, Stories

Spotlights



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Partnering with YouTube and TED-Ed to Enrich Classrooms with Music Education

October 10, 2025

ETM has partnered with TED-ED and YouTube to launch “Think Like a Musician” — a new educational series that explores the creative mindset of working musicians through artist interviews, animation, and interactive learning.

[Read More](#)


Teacher Spotlight: Jade Brathwaite

September 8, 2025

Meet ETM teacher Jade Brathwaite! Jade joined us as a music teacher intern during the 2024-2025 school year as a part of ETM's Music Teacher Workforce Development Program. With ETM alumni Leah Thakur as her mentor...

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